

Answer check in three ways

Foundations

THE IDEA

When checked, examine king moves, captures of the checking piece, and blocks of a checking line. A knight check cannot be blocked. In a double check, the king must move because one ordinary capture or block cannot resolve both attacks.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A bishop checking along a diagonal might be met by interposing a piece. A knight checking from f7 cannot be stopped by placing something between it and the king. The geometry determines which defensive methods are available.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why should you inspect captures before automatically moving the king?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Capturing the checker may retain castling rights or improve the position. But the capturing move must be legal and leave the king safe from every other attacker.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

List legal defenses before choosing the most attractive one.